Bulletin

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GOVERNANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · INCLUSION · GEOPOLITICS

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

- **Livre Blanc et adressage postal : l'ARPCE pose les fondations de l'État numérique** — Les Dépêches de Brazzaville, 17 October 2026 CONGO

  Congo's regulator ARPCE presented the second edition of its Livre Blanc and a digital postal-addressing project in Brazzaville on 15 October 2026. The minister asked that addressing be built as public infrastructure that works with digital ID, the data-exchange platform and payments, and the Livre Blanc's conclusions go to the interministerial task force on digitalising the administration. *Also under Registries and Access to services.*

Data protection

- **JUSTICE – Un logiciel d'anonymisation pour permettre aux magistrats d'utiliser l'IA sans exposer les données des justiciables** — 2424.mg, 17 October 2026 MADAGASCAR

  Madagascar's Conseil d'État has given all magistrates software that removes litigants' personal data from case files before any AI tool is used, presented at an AI workshop at the Cour suprême on 15-16 October 2026. Built without public money, it is the first step of a Conseil d'État and ENMG programme training magistrates to use consumer AI tools, under the personal data protection law. *Also under AI.*

- **Gouvernance : mobiliser les ressources publiques** — Les Dépêches de Brazzaville, 17 October 2026 CONGO

  Opening the National Assembly's budget session on 15 October 2026, its president Isidore Mvouba asked the Congolese government to make the National Commission for the Protection of Personal Data operational promptly. He linked digital sovereignty to control over health, civil-status, education, tax and social-protection data.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

- **Sam George gives contractors 30 days to finish rural telephony sites or face penalties** — Adom Online, 17 October 2026 GHANA

  Ghana's communications minister Sam George gave Rural Telephony Project contractors 30 days to finish outstanding sites or face penalties, saying they have been paid in full, after touring sites in the Volta Region. He also said Ghana recorded more than 4,000 fibre cuts by June 2026 and operators spent over $20 million on fibre repairs in 2025. *Also under Rural digital data capture.*

- **FG begins 3,700 rural connectivity tower rollout in Abia** — The Punch, 17 October 2026 NIGERIA

Nigeria's communications minister Bosun Tijani commissioned the first of 3,700 rural sites under the Nigeria Universal Communication Access Project in Bende, Abia State, on 16 October 2026. IHS Towers subsidiary GICL is deploying the towers with public Wi-Fi and Smart Village kits, starting at seven locations across Abia, Delta, Enugu, Plateau, Katsina and Ogun. *Also under Digital divides*.

DPI

Data Exchange

- **Digitalisation de l'administration : le comité de pilotage fixe ses priorités** — Les Dépêches de Brazzaville, 17 October 2026 CONGO

  The steering committee of Congo's task force on digitalising the administration, created by decree 2026-261 of 29 January 2026, met for the first time on 15 October 2026 and chose four priorities. They are e-visas and entry authorisation before visa-free entry for Africans from January 2027, digital criminal records and birth certificates, a clean-up of the civil-service personnel file, and data sharing between revenue agencies and land administration. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov and Registries*.

Digital Identity and CRVS

- **Benin launches app letting public-sector retirees provide proof of life remotely** — Ecofin Agency, 17 October 2026 BENIN

  Benin launched Preuve de Vie on 15 October 2026, a mobile app through which public-sector pensioners of the FNRB confirm they are alive using their NPI, pension booklet number and fingerprint, from Benin or abroad. Biometric kiosks taking the national ID card are an alternative, and the campaign runs to 15 November 2026. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov*.

Digital Payments and Fintech

- **Payment hurdles ease for businesses** — Malawi24, 17 October 2026 MALAWI

  The Reserve Bank of Malawi issued fintech PayChangu payment service provider licence PSP-003/26 on 30 September 2026 under the Payment Systems Act 2016. It allows the firm to aggregate mobile money, card and bank-transfer payments on one platform.

- **CBN moves to ease Nigeria-China payments as Cardoso takes talks to Beijing** — Nairametrics, 17 October 2026 NIGERIA

  Central Bank of Nigeria governor Olayemi Cardoso said he met People's Bank of China governor Pan Gongsheng at the IMF-World Bank annual meetings to discuss cross-border payments, settlement, fintech and trade finance. He said Nigeria will pursue these on a coming visit to Beijing; no plans or timetable were disclosed. *Also under China activities*.

Registries

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  Summarised under Data Exchange.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

- **Deuxième édition du Forum international des Secrétariats généraux de gouvernement : les travaux s'achèvent sur d'importantes recommandations - Lesinfosdeguinee** — lesinfosdeguinee.com, 17 October 2026 GUINEA

  The second International Forum of Government General Secretariats, on AI for government performance, closed in Conakry on 16 October 2026 with delegates from 14 African and European countries. Its recommendations cover responsible AI use in administrations, staff training and data governance, expanding the secretariats' network, and better law-making, including digital official gazettes and interoperable platforms. *Also under AI.*

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Digitalisation

Rural digital data capture

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Technology

AI

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Inclusion

Access to services

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Digital divides

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Geopolitics

China activities

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ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	**2026-10-18**
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Bulletins are kept for a week — the last week's editions are listed above, each at its own dated address — and are then deleted. Older material is in the country and region news.